

Florida Beach Investor Plan 2027

Business plan, market study, competitive map, prospecting system, and personal study guide for capturing \$600k+ non-condo beach investors from Santa Rosa Beach to Panama City.

\$1,000,000

2027 gross commission income target · 2.5% average · \$40M closed volume · ~40 sides

Prepared for Gene Darden · Team Leader, The Darden Group · Real Broker LLC | Powered by PLACE

Florida licensed (2024) · Alabama licensed (2009) · SRS · Accredited investor · 2,000+ homes sold

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Educational planning document. Tax and legal items are study notes, not advice. Confirm with a CPA and a Florida attorney.

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How to read the data in this plan. Figures marked **HARD** were reported by a named source. Figures marked **EST** are derived from hard aggregates using stated assumptions, because no public source publishes "non-condo closings at \$600k and up" for Walton and Bay counties. The first task in the sprint is to run the MLS query in the Appendix, which replaces every estimate with an exact count in about ten minutes.

1. Executive summary



The thesis. The \$600k-and-up single-family and townhome market from Santa Rosa Beach to Panama City is large (roughly \$3.4 billion a year **EST**), growing (30A closings up about 35% year to date, Panama City Beach up about 19% **HARD**), and dominated by luxury-lifestyle teams that do not speak the investor's language. Nobody in the corridor publishes real underwriting, tax strategy, or verified rental actuals. The top 30A teams average \$2M to \$3.4M per sale and sell lifestyle. The STR-investor space is held by one national team (The Short Term Shop) and a few solo bloggers, mostly at condo and entry-level price points. The \$600k to \$2M investor buyer who wants the numbers run, the tax engine explained, and the rules de-risked is underserved. That is the lane.

The number. One million dollars of gross commission at 2.5% is \$40 million of closed volume. At a \$1.0M average price that is 40 sides, or 3.3 closings a month. That is about 1% of the sides and 1.2% of the dollars in the segment. It is a real stretch for a first full year in a market where Gene has a license, a CPAR membership, a Panama City Beach listing, and a YouTube channel, but no established 30A presence. The plan treats \$1M as the stretch goal and \$600k as the floor (24 sides), with the pipeline and activity math built for the stretch.

The edge. Gene is an accredited investor with 2,000 closings, a published investor calculator, and an SRS designation. The plan builds the brand "The Coastal Blueprint" around three things no competitor is doing together: (1) a free, interactive beach-home pro forma with after-tax returns, (2) plain-English teaching on the short-term rental tax rules, cost segregation and 100% bonus depreciation, and 1031 exchanges, and (3) a verified-actuals standard: every property is presented with trailing-12 rental actuals, not projections.

The system. Four lead engines, run on a weekly cadence: out-of-state owner prospecting (Walton and Bay property-appraiser exports), the Birmingham/Atlanta/Nashville feeder-market network (Gene's existing database and sphere), the Coastal Blueprint YouTube and newsletter machine, and a partner bench (property managers, DSCR lenders, cost-seg firms, 1031 intermediaries, CPAs) that co-hosts quarterly investor workshops. The dedicated Florida line, 850-964-3554, is the call-to-action on everything Florida-facing.

The clock. Beach buyers decide in two windows: January to April (visits, snowbird season, tax refunds) and September to December (year-end tax motivation: a property placed in service by December 31 takes 100% bonus depreciation in that tax year). Closings in Q1 2027 come from contracts written in November and December 2026. The 90-day sprint exists to put 10 to 15 qualified investors under contract or in active search before January 1.

Bottom line for the next 7 days: run the MLS query, build the out-of-state owner list, publish the "Beach Investor Underwriting" offer on the calculator site with the 850 line, book the ECAR secondary membership, and start the five-a-day investor conversation habit. Everything else layers on top.

2. The goal and the math

2.1 From \$1M to daily activity

Average sale price	Sides needed	Per month	Per week	Share of segment sides EST
\$650,000	62	5.1	1.2	1.5%
\$800,000	50	4.2	1.0	1.2%
\$950,000 (plan)	42	3.5	0.8	1.0%
\$1,200,000	33	2.8	0.6	0.8%
\$1,500,000	27	2.2	0.5	0.7%

The plan assumes a blended average of about \$950k to \$1.0M: Walton County product skews above \$1M, Bay County product sits in the \$600k to \$900k band. Every \$100k of average price removes about four closings from the requirement, which is why the plan pushes toward 30A and Inlet Beach even though Panama City Beach is the easier first entry.

2.2 Side mix target (40 sides)

Lane	Sides	Volume	Where they come from
Investor buyers (STR / second-home / 1031)	24	\$24M	Feeder-market network, YouTube, calculator, workshops, DSCR lender and CPA referrals
Listings from out-of-state owners	10	\$10M	Property-appraiser owner lists, "exit and 1031" campaign, PM partner referrals, expired/withdrawn luxury listings
Double-ends, referrals, team/agent referrals	6	\$6M	Darden Group sphere, Real/PLACE agent referral network, past clients

2.3 The funnel (annual, built for 40 sides)

Stage	Annual	Monthly	Conversion assumption
Closings	40	3.3	
Signed buyer agreements + listing agreements	80	6.7	50% close within 12 months (investors take 2 to 9 months)
Strategy consults (45-minute underwriting session)	200	17	40% sign
Real investor conversations (two-way, qualified)	1,250	104	16% book a consult
Contacts attempted (calls, texts, DMs, emails, letters)	~8,000	~670	~15% become a conversation

The daily standard: 5 real investor conversations a day, 250 working days. Not dials, not posts: conversations with someone who owns, wants to own, or is selling a beach property worth \$600k or more. Track it in Brivity. Nothing in this plan works without this habit. 1,250 conversations a year is the engine; the rest is amplification.

2.4 Income reality check

Scenario	Sides	Avg price	Volume	GCI at 2.5%	Note
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Floor	24	\$900k	\$21.6M	\$540k	Two closings a month. Likely if the sprint lands 10 contracts by January.
Base	32	\$950k	\$30.4M	\$760k	Requires the owner-list listing lane to produce.
Stretch (the goal)	40	\$1.0M	\$40M	\$1.0M	Requires a buyer's agent or ISA by Q2 2027 and the partner-workshop engine running.

GCI is gross. Brokerage splits, PLACE fees, team compensation, and the cost budget in Section 13 come out of it. Net is Gene's to model in Wealth Command.

3. The market in 2026

Scope: Walton County (Santa Rosa Beach, Scenic 30A from Dune Allen to Inlet Beach, Miramar Beach and Sandestin, Freeport, Point Washington) and Bay County (Panama City Beach, Laguna Beach, Carillon, Panama City, Lynn Haven, Mexico Beach). Property types: single-family and townhomes only. No condos.

3.1 How many \$600k+ non-condo homes have sold in 2026 so far

Area	Jan–Aug 2026	Through Sept (extrapolated)	Of which \$1M+	Full-year 2026 pace
Walton County	EST 870–1,110 (central ~1,000)	~980–1,250	~580–720	~1,500
Bay County	EST 300–410 (central ~350)	~330–450	~80–120	~525
Combined	~1,170–1,520 (central ~1,350)	~1,300–1,700	~660–840	~2,000

Dollar volume. **EST** \$2.1 to \$2.4 billion Jan–Aug 2026 in the segment (Walton ~\$1.9B at ~\$1.9M average, Bay ~\$0.33B at ~\$0.95M average), on pace for roughly \$3.4 billion for the full year. The segment median is roughly \$1.2M to \$1.4M, Walton-weighted.

What the estimates are built on (all **HARD**):

- 893 closings on Scenic 30A Jan–Aug 2026, up about 35% versus the same period in 2025; YTD median \$1.68M, average \$2.48M; active inventory 898 in August 2026 versus 1,238 in August 2025 (down 27%). 30A condos were about 12 to 18% of closings in prior years.
- Walton County: 3,957 sales trailing 12 months, county median \$709k in June 2026 (up 12.6%); Santa Rosa Beach median \$928k, \$490/sq ft, 98 days on market; Miramar Beach median ~\$714k to \$729k, 537 closings in the last six months, 99 days to contract; Rosemary Beach median \$2.9M (up 13.4%).
- Panama City Beach: 1,640 closings Jan–Aug 2026, up 19.2%; August median \$399k (all types); single-family average sale price \$801k in February 2026 (up 27%); active inventory ~1,827 (down 11.4%). Bay County median ~\$356k, 76 days on market. Panama City sales up 18.6% in June.
- Luxury markers: \$41M record sale between Alys and Rosemary (April 2026), \$16.7M record in Blue Mountain Beach, 18 sales above \$10M in 2025 totaling \$238M. ZIP 32459 sales up 79.5% year over year as of May 2026, the fastest in Florida.

Replace these estimates in week one. Run the Flexmls closed-sales query in the Appendix (Residential Detached + Townhouse, sold price ≥ \$600,000, closed 1/1/2026 to date, Walton and Bay) through CPAR, and through ECAR once the secondary membership is active. Record the count, the dollar volume, the median, and the cash-buyer share in the scorecard. Repeat on the first business day of every month; that monthly number becomes the "Beach Investor Brief" headline stat.

3.2 Trend read

- Volume is up sharply, inventory is down.** 30A closings +35%, PCB +19%, inventory down 11 to 27%. Buyers came back in 2026 after two slow years. Pending contracts are rising.
- Prices are split.** 30A luxury is up (YTD median +8%, Rosemary +13%, county +12.6% in June). Mid-market Santa Rosa Beach is flat to slightly down (–2.4%). Panama City Beach and Bay County are flat to down (–0.8% to –5.5%), driven by condo weakness (HOA and insurance costs). This is exactly the spread an investor-focused agent can trade: value in Bay County and west 30A, appreciation in east 30A.
- Days on market are long.** 98 to 138 days in most sub-markets. Sellers who overprice sit; buyers with a disciplined underwriting model have leverage. "Buy it right" is the message.

- **Buyer mix.** Predominantly out-of-area: Atlanta, Nashville, Dallas, Birmingham, Houston. Second-home, investment, and legacy purchases. Many cash buyers, and a year-end tax-motivated cash surge. A large share of sellers are also out of state, which makes the owner-list listing lane viable.
- **Tourism base is healthy.** Walton County bed tax ~\$60.3M in FY2025 (flat), South Walton FY26 collections up 10.4% through March. Bay County bed tax \$32.5M for 10 months ending July 2026 (up 7%), July 2026 up 13%. More than 5M visitors and \$3.1B direct spend in Bay County. Walton is actively enforcing against unregistered rentals in 2026, which favors buyers who register properly.

3.3 Short-term rental benchmarks (**HARD** unless noted)

Market	Active listings	Occupancy	ADR	Avg annual revenue	Source
Santa Rosa Beach / 30A	3,383	54%	\$693	\$70,400 (revenue +3%, occupancy +4% YoY)	AirDNA 2026
Panama City Beach	4,057	61%	\$288	\$50,200 (revenue +20.9% Aug 2025 to Aug 2026)	AirDNA 2026
Panama City Beach	2,395		\$212	\$43,040	Rabbu, Apr 2026
PCB 3BR / 4BR homes				3BR median \$33.4k (75th pct \$50.4k); 4BR median \$48.7k (75th pct \$72.2k)	Short Term Shop 2026
30A Gulf-front 5–6BR (Rosemary, Alys, WaterColor)				\$250k–\$400k+; Gulf-front grosses 8–12% of price	Short Term Shop 2026

Implied yields **EST:** gross 6% to 9% of purchase price for well-located homes; after 20 to 25% management, 5% bed tax plus 7% sales tax collected from guests, insurance, property tax at the reassessed value, utilities, and maintenance, net cap rates run about 3% to 5%. Cash-on-cash before tax is often thin or negative with 2026 rates; the return is appreciation, principal paydown, personal use, and the tax engine. That is why the after-tax pro forma is the selling tool, and why Gene's tax fluency is the differentiator.

4. Where the deals are

4.1 Micro-market map (non-condo, \$600k+)

Micro-market	Typical price band	Investor angle	Watch-outs
Inlet Beach / Seacrest / Rosemary / Alys (east 30A)	\$1.5M–\$5M+	Highest ADR and repeat-guest base; strongest appreciation; legacy buyers; cottages and townhomes in Seacrest Beach and Inlet Beach are the entry point	HOA rental rules vary by community; verify STR permission in the deed restrictions before writing
Seagrove / Seaside / WaterColor / Grayton	\$1.2M–\$4M	Established rental programs; walkable; year-round demand	Older cottages need capex; WaterColor and Seaside have program and design constraints
Blue Mountain / Gulf Place / Santa Rosa Beach south of 98 (west 30A)	\$700k–\$2M	Best value on 30A; new construction; room for ADR growth	Longer DOM (98+); price with discipline
Dune Allen / Topsail / Miramar Beach / Sandestin	\$600k–\$1.5M	Golf and bay access; Sandestin resort rental machine; cheaper entry	Sandestin fees and gate rules; Miramar inventory heavy (285 active)
Santa Rosa Beach north of 98 / Point Washington / Freeport	\$600k–\$1.1M	Mid-term and long-term rental, relocation buyers, workforce housing demand	STR revenue drops sharply off the beach; underwrite as LTR
Panama City Beach West End (32413) / Laguna Beach / Carillon	\$600k–\$1.5M	The unowned segment. New-build beach houses and townhomes two blocks from the sand; ADR gains (+20.9%); PCB Ordinance 1632 is predictable; no caps or minimum stays	Insurance and flood zone (VE/AE) costs; verify zoning district allows STR; HOA rules in newer townhome projects
Panama City (The Cove, bayfront) / Lynn Haven waterfront	\$600k–\$1.2M	Primary-home and executive relocation; bay docks; long-term rental to military and medical	Thin \$600k+ volume; not STR product
Mexico Beach	\$600k–\$1.5M	Post-Michael rebuild, elevated new construction, lower entry for Gulf-front; quieter rental season	Insurance, shorter rental season, smaller buyer pool on exit

4.2 The deal screen (what "a good deal" means here)

Every property Gene presents to an investor passes through the same screen, in this order. The screen is the product. Publish it; it becomes the brand.

- 1. Can it legally rent?** County/city STR certificate eligibility (Walton VRC, PCB Ord. 1632), zoning, HOA covenants, DBPR license path. If no, it is a second home, not an investment. Underwrite accordingly.
- 2. What did it actually gross?** Trailing-12 owner statements or PM actuals. No actuals: use AirDNA/Rabbu comps by bedroom count and distance to beach, then haircut 15%.
- 3. What does it cost to carry?** Property tax at the reassessed purchase price (not the seller's capped bill), wind and flood insurance quotes in hand before the inspection period ends, HOA, management at 20 to 25%, utilities, 5% to 8% maintenance and supplies, 3% to 5% capex reserve.
- 4. What does the debt look like?** Second-home (10% down, lower rate, personal use required) versus DSCR (20 to 25% down, 1.0 to 1.25x coverage on AirDNA or actuals) versus cash. Jumbo thresholds matter above the 2026 conforming

limit.

5. **What is the after-tax year-one?** Cost-seg estimate (20 to 35% of depreciable basis into 5/7/15-year property) with 100% bonus depreciation; STR material-participation test feasibility for this buyer; marginal bracket; the resulting cash tax savings. Section 10 has the method.
6. **What is the five-year hold?** Appreciation at a conservative 3% to 4%, principal paydown, exit at a cap rate 50 bps above today's, selling cost 6%, depreciation recapture at 25%, NIIT 3.8%, and the 1031 option. Internal rate of return on all four engines.
7. **What is the downside?** Occupancy -15%, ADR -10%, insurance +25%, rate +100 bps. Does it still carry? Can the buyer fund a negative year without stress?

Gene's rule of thumb for the corridor (publish it): Buy gross rent at 7% or better of price with verified actuals, insure before you inspect, underwrite the tax engine as a bonus and never as the reason, and only buy what you would be happy to own empty for a season.

4.3 Where "good deals" surface

- **Overpriced-and-sitting luxury listings** at 120+ DOM with two or more price cuts (search Flexmls weekly). Sellers are often out-of-state owners tired of management; a clean DSCR or cash offer at a 7% gross yield wins.
- **Expired and withdrawn listings** \$800k+ in Walton and Bay from the last 24 months. Owners already decided to sell once.
- **Out-of-state owners with 10+ years of ownership** (property-appraiser export). Large embedded gains, aging owners, 1031 or step-up conversations.
- **New construction in PCB West End and west 30A** from builders holding specs: negotiate rate buydowns and furnishings packages; new build means lower insurance (2020+ code), full cost-seg basis, and warranty.
- **Estates and divorces** via Walton and Bay probate filings and local attorneys.
- **PM partner "owner wants out" lists.** Every property manager knows which owners are tired. A referral agreement with two 30A and two PCB managers is a listing pipeline.

5. Competition

Verified from RealTrends Verified 2026 profiles, press releases, and brokerage sites via search snippets. V = third-party verified, S = self-reported.

5.1 Who is winning on 30A

Team	Brokerage	2025 production	Positioning
Spears Group (Jonathan Spears)	Compass	\$398M, 20 agents, avg ~\$2.1M (V)	Luxury; only top team publishing finance explainers (DSCR, rental income)
Dahler & Co. (Brad Dahler)	Scenic Sotheby's	\$386M, 115 sides, avg \$3.36M (V)	Ultra-luxury Gulf-front; publishes its own "30A team rankings" page
Blankenship Watkins Advisory Group	Christie's Emerald Coast (launched 2025, 130 agents)	\$360M, ~220 sides on 2024 data (V)	Luxury east 30A
Kendall Hood Collection	Compass	82 transactions, ~\$120M, avg \$1.5M (S); #1 medium team Seagrove (V)	Luxury plus "investment and vacation rentals"; Compass Resort; relocation guide lead magnet
Erin Oden / Coastal Luxury	Own brokerage, Seacrest	\$1B+ career (S); no current figure	Only established team tagged "second home and investment"; content is dated
Linda Miller ("The Smile of 30A")	Own brokerage	~\$1B career (S)	Rosemary Beach east-end luxury
Brokerages	Scenic Sotheby's \$1.7B in 2025 (S); Engel & Völkers 30A \$558M / 393 sides in 2024 (V); Corcoran Reverie \$4.2B cumulative (V); BHHS Beach Properties ~90 agents on 30A		Lifestyle luxury; none investor-positioned

5.2 Who is winning in Panama City Beach

Agent / team	Brokerage	Production	Positioning
The Duran Group (Craig Duran)	BHHS Beach Properties	"#1 PCB agent by 2025 volume" (S); \$500M+ career; Chairman's Circle Diamond (V)	General resale, YouTube channel
Zack Seltzer	Seltzer Real Estate (own, with in-house PM)	#1 PCB individual, 46 sides, \$23.9M in 2025 (V, RealTrends)	STR/condo investor specialist, avg ~\$520k per side; paid "#1" press releases
The Short Term Shop (Avery Carl)	eXp	National: "\$3.5B STR sold, 5,000+ investors" (S)	Owns STR-investor SEO for PCB and 30A; publishes 2026 revenue data; condo and entry-level weighted
Counts Real Estate (130+ agents), Beachy Beach (80+ agents)	Independent	Headcount leaders; no producer data	General

Scale gap to note: the #1 PCB individual did \$24M in 2025. The \$600k+ single-family and townhome investor segment in Bay County is thin and nobody owns it. On 30A, the volume leaders average \$2M to \$3.4M per side and are not returns-positioned.

5.3 What the successful ones do

- **Blog clusters for investor keywords** ("30A investment property guide 2026", "best 30A neighborhoods for rental income", "how much do STRs make in PCB"). Mid-tier solo agents and PM companies rank, not the big teams.
- **Static lead magnets:** relocation guides, neighborhood lists, regulation summaries. No calculators, no downloadable pro formas, no quarterly data reports surfaced anywhere in the corridor.
- **PM partnerships:** 360 Blue runs a formal "Realtor Connection" program with data and projections; Dune Allen Realty and Seltzer bundle sales with management; Oversee publicly tells owners to demand "actuals, not projections."
- **DSCR lenders** target the corridor directly (Lendmire, Ridge Street Capital, Pinnacle Funding); "DSCR on AirDNA" is the standard qualifying path.
- **Credibility signals:** RealTrends badges, Zillow/FastExpert "top agent" awards, Best of Emerald Coast, paid newswire releases, Real Producers Emerald Coast magazine.
- **Video:** Duran and Spears run YouTube; "Mr. Beach" (5,780 subs) leads the local lifestyle channel space; the "does it pay for itself" format has proven demand.

5.4 The gaps we attack

Gap	Our move
Nobody publishes real underwriting; content stops at "8–12% gross, PM takes 20–25%"	The Gulf Coast Investor Calculator, upgraded with 30A/PCB defaults by micro-market and bedroom count, DSCR sizing, after-tax cash-on-cash. Free, no email wall, 850 line on it.
Zero agent content on the STR material-participation rule, cost segregation, bonus depreciation, 1031 into 30A	The Coastal Blueprint "Numbers" lane: one long-form a week on exactly these topics with a CPA or cost-seg partner on camera.
Buyer distrust of PM projections	The Verified Actuals Standard: every property Gene presents includes trailing-12 actuals or is labeled "projection only."
PCB \$600k+ SFH/townhome investor segment is unowned	Own it first (CPAR member, existing PCB presence), then move east with the ECAR membership.
No investor events, no 1031 or cost-seg workshops in SRB or PCB	Quarterly "Beach Investor Workshop" co-hosted with a cost-seg firm, a 1031 intermediary, and a DSCR lender. First one in Birmingham (feeder market), second on 30A.
Everyone markets listings; buyer-side advisory is under-marketed post-NAR	A published buyer-advisory offer with a transparent 2.5% to 3% buyer-broker agreement and a seller-concession playbook.
Regulatory change tracking lives with PM firms	Monthly "Beach Investor Brief" newsletter: the MLS count, STR rule changes, insurance news, tax calendar.

6. Positioning: The Darden Edge

6.1 One sentence

Gene Darden helps investors buy and sell \$600k+ beach homes from 30A to Panama City Beach by the numbers: verified rental actuals, after-tax returns, and the rules de-risked before you write the offer.

6.2 Proof points (all true today, use verbatim)

- 2,000+ homes sold across 17 years of residential, commercial, and investment real estate.
- Accredited investor who underwrites every deal: cash flow, cap rate, cash-on-cash, DSCR, after-tax.
- Licensed in Florida and Alabama; Seller Representative Specialist (SRS); member of the Central Panhandle Association of Realtors.
- Publishes the free Gulf Coast Investor Calculator and The Coastal Blueprint on YouTube.
- Serves the feeder markets: Birmingham, Hoover, and the Southeast investor community that buys this coast.

6.3 The offer (what a prospect gets)

1. **The 45-minute Beach Investor Strategy Session** (free, by phone or Zoom): goals, capital, financing path, tax position, personal-use intent, and the three micro-markets that fit. Ends with a written one-page "Buy Box."
2. **Underwriting on every property**: the seven-step deal screen in Section 4.2, delivered as a one-page pro forma PDF with verified actuals.
3. **The partner bench**: vetted property managers (two per market), DSCR and second-home lenders, cost-seg firm, 1031 qualified intermediary, STR-fluent CPA, insurance broker with coastal carriers, inspector, and a Florida closing attorney or title company.
4. **Rules de-risked**: STR certificate eligibility, HOA covenants, flood zone and CCCL status, insurance quotes, all before the inspection period ends.
5. **Exit planning**: hold analysis, 1031 timeline, and a listing strategy (SRS) when it is time to trade up.

6.4 Brand architecture

Asset	Role	Action
The Darden Group · Real Broker LLC Powered by PLACE	Entity, compliance, Equal Housing	Add Florida license number and 850 line to every Florida page and post
The Coastal Blueprint with Gene Darden (YouTube, @livingonemeraldcoast)	Investor education flagship	Numbers lane leads; weekly long-form Thursday 7am; Shorts Tue/Fri/Sun
Gulf Coast Investor Calculator (gene-darden.github.io/investor-calculator)	Lead magnet and proof	Add Florida beach-home presets, 850 line, and the Strategy Session booking link
dardengroupusa.com/florida (new)	Florida landing page	Offer, proof points, calculator, Brief signup, 850 line, FAQ schema
850-964-3554	Florida call/text line	Every Florida-facing CTA. Route to Gene's cell; set a Florida voicemail; tag inbound in Brivity as "FL-850"
The Beach Investor Brief (monthly email)	Nurture	Launch November 1; first issue carries the MLS count and the year-end bonus-depreciation deadline

6.5 Compliance line on everything tax-related

"Educational only. Not tax, legal, or investment advice. Outcomes depend on your facts; confirm with your CPA and attorney." Gene frames, partners advise. Confirm E&O coverage for investment-analysis marketing.

7. Marketing and prospecting system

7.1 The four lead engines

Engine	Target	Weekly action	Owner	2027 sides
A. Out-of-state owner prospecting	Walton + Bay non-condo owners with non-Florida mailing addresses, assessed \$500k+, held 5+ years. Prioritize AL, GA, TN, TX, LA mailing states.	Mon: 50 letters (hand-signed, 850 line). Tue–Thu: 60 skip-traced calls/texts. Monthly: one piece of mail to the full list (Brief postcard).	Gene + Christy (mail), ISA by Q2	10 listings + 4 buyers
B. Feeder-market network	Gene's Birmingham database (past clients, sphere, Hoover professionals, physicians, business owners, Real/PLACE agents), Atlanta and Nashville referral agents.	Daily: 3 "who do you know buying at the beach" conversations. Monthly: Beach Investor Brief to the whole database. Quarterly: Birmingham workshop.	Gene	12 buyers + 4 referrals
C. Coastal Blueprint content	Out-of-state investors searching YouTube and Google for "30A investment property", "does a PCB beach house pay for itself", "STR tax loophole Florida".	1 long-form + 3 Shorts, 1 blog page with the numbers, 1 Google Business post, Buffer to IG/FB/LinkedIn/X/Threads/TikTok. Calculator link and 850 line in every description.	Gene (shoot Mon), Claude (edit, post, captions, replies)	8 buyers
D. Partner bench	Property managers (360 Blue Realtor Connection, Benchmark, Dune Allen, Oversee, Southern, Vacasa local), DSCR lenders, cost-seg firms (KBKG, ETS), 1031 QIs (IPX1031, API), CPAs (Hall CPA, Keystone, a Birmingham CPA), insurance brokers.	2 partner meetings a week in Q4; one co-branded piece a month; quarterly workshop.	Gene	6 buyers + 2 listings

7.2 The weekly operating rhythm

Day	Block	What
Monday	7–9a prospecting · 10a–1p shoot day · 2–4p partner meetings	50 owner letters out; shoot the week's long-form and three Shorts; two partner calls
Tuesday	7–10a prospecting · afternoon showings/consults	Owner calls and feeder-network calls (5 conversations minimum); Short publishes
Wednesday	7–10a prospecting · afternoon underwriting	Pro formas for active buyers; Flexmls "sitting listings" sweep (120+ DOM, 2+ cuts)
Thursday	7a long-form publishes · 7–10a prospecting · afternoon consults	Strategy Sessions stacked Thursday afternoons; blog page with the numbers goes live
Friday	7–9a prospecting · 9–11a scorecard · afternoon Florida day prep	Scorecard update; Short publishes; confirm weekend showings
Sat/Sun (2 weekends a month in Florida)	Showings, PM and partner visits, property tours on camera	Sunday Short publishes

7.3 Lead magnets and content calendar (first 12 weeks)

Week	Long-form (Numbers / Moving / Things)	Blog page title	Lead magnet step
1	"How many \$600k+ beach homes sold from 30A to PCB in 2026 (the real count)"	2026 Beach Home Sales Report: Santa Rosa Beach to Panama City	Calculator gets Florida presets + 850 line
2	"Does a \$900k Panama City Beach house pay for itself? Full underwriting"	PCB West End beach house pro forma 2026	Beach Investor Brief signup live
3	"The STR tax rule high earners use on beach homes (with a CPA)"	Short-term rental loophole explained for Florida beach homes	Strategy Session booking page
4	Moving: "Santa Rosa Beach vs Panama City Beach: cost, rules, lifestyle"	Same	FL landing page live
5	"Cost segregation on a \$1.2M 30A home: year-one math"	Cost segregation and bonus depreciation on 30A homes	Cost-seg partner co-brand
6	Things: "A 30A weekend as an owner, not a tourist"	Same	
7	"Buy by December 31: the year-end beach investor deadline"	Year-end tax deadline for beach home buyers	Q4 email campaign
8	"Walton County STR certificate and PCB Ordinance 1632: what buyers must know"	Walton and PCB short-term rental rules 2026	Rules checklist PDF
9	"DSCR vs second-home loan on a beach house: which wins?"	Same	Lender co-brand
10	Moving: "What insurance really costs on a \$1M beach home in 2026"	Beach home insurance costs Walton and Bay County	Insurance broker co-brand
11	"1031 into 30A: how Birmingham investors trade up to the beach"	1031 exchange into a 30A rental	QI co-brand; Birmingham workshop invite
12	"2027 beach investor outlook: the numbers I'm watching"	2027 outlook	Workshop registration

7.4 Using 850-964-3554

- Put it on: calculator site, Florida landing page, YouTube descriptions and end cards, owner letters, postcards, Google Business Profile (as the Florida number), Zillow and Realtor.com Florida profile, email signature for Florida threads, business cards for Florida.
- Set a dedicated voicemail: "You've reached Gene Darden's Florida line, The Darden Group. If you're calling about a beach property or investment from 30A to Panama City Beach, leave your name, the area you're looking at, and the best time to call. I return every call the same day."
- Text-first: owner letters say "text BEACH to 850-964-3554 for your property's rental actuals estimate." Inbound texts auto-tag "FL-850" in Brivity and trigger the Strategy Session offer.
- Track: every inbound on the 850 line is a Florida lead; weekly count goes on the scorecard.

7.5 Paid amplification (start small, scale on proof)

- Google Search ads on "30A investment property", "Panama City Beach investment property", "30A rental income", "beach house tax deduction Florida": \$600 to \$900 a month, landing on the calculator and Strategy Session. Start week 4.

- YouTube in-feed promotion of the two best Numbers videos to Birmingham, Atlanta, Nashville, Dallas, Houston, 35 to 65, household income top 10%: \$300 a month.
- Meta retargeting of calculator and landing-page visitors with the Brief signup: \$200 a month.
- Direct mail to the owner list: ~\$1 to \$1.50 per piece, 500 to 1,000 pieces a month.

8. 90-day launch sprint: October 4 to December 31, 2026

Goal of the sprint: 10 to 15 qualified investors under contract or in active, signed search by January 1; the four engines running; the Verified Actuals brand visible in both counties.

Week	Dates	Must-do (in order)	Scorecard check
1	Oct 5–11	Run the MLS query (Appendix). Pull Walton and Bay property-appraiser tax rolls; filter non-FL mailing addresses, non-condo, \$500k+ assessed, 5+ years held. Load into PropStream for skip-trace. Add 850 line + Florida presets to the calculator. Set up 850 voicemail and Brivity tag. Apply for ECAR secondary membership (Letter of Good Standing from Birmingham board). Pay CPAR 2026 dues before Nov 1 for the 10% discount. Start Hall CPA STR Tax Course. Shoot video 1.	Owner list built (target 2,500+ records). 25 conversations.
2	Oct 12–18	First 50 owner letters out. First 60 skip-traced calls. Book first 2 PM partner meetings (one 30A, one PCB) and one DSCR lender. Brief signup live. Google Business Profile: add Florida service areas and the 850 line. Shoot video 2. Read IRS Pub 527 and 925.	25 conversations. 2 consults booked.
3	Oct 19–25	Florida weekend: tour 10 active \$600k+ listings in PCB West End and west 30A on camera; meet both PMs in person; collect two sets of trailing-12 actuals. Strategy Session booking page live. Shoot video 3 with a CPA. RSPS webinar booked.	25 conversations. 3 consults.
4	Oct 26–Nov 1	Beach Investor Brief issue #1 to the full database (MLS count, year-end deadline, one deal breakdown). Google Search ads live. Florida landing page live. Cost-seg firm partner call (KBKG or ETS). First 1031 QI webinar.	25 conversations. 4 consults. First signed buyer agreement.
5	Nov 2–8	Year-end campaign starts: "Buy by Dec 31" email + video + owner postcard. 10 pro formas delivered to active buyers. Second Florida weekend: showings. ECAR orientation if scheduled.	25 conversations. 5 consults. 2 signed.
6	Nov 9–15	Birmingham workshop date set for first week of December (cost-seg + QI + lender on the panel). Invite list: database + owner list in AL. Expired/withdrawn luxury listing campaign (24 months) begins.	25 conversations. 3 signed cumulative.
7	Nov 16–22	First offers written. Insurance broker co-brand video. Second Brief draft. NAR REI online bundle started.	First contract.
8	Nov 23–29	Thanksgiving week: content bank only; 15 conversations; family.	15 conversations.
9	Nov 30–Dec 6	Birmingham Beach Investor Workshop. Brief issue #2. Listing lane: first out-of-state owner listing appointment(s).	30 attendees. 5 consults from workshop.
10	Dec 7–13	Third Florida weekend. Close out year-end buyers (inspection, insurance, STR certificate path). 2027 content calendar built.	3 contracts cumulative.
11	Dec 14–20	Partner bench complete (2 PMs per market, 2 lenders, cost-seg, QI, CPA, insurance, inspector, title). Hire/assign ISA plan for Q1. Budget locked.	5+ contracts cumulative.
12–13	Dec 21–31	Year-end closings. Brief issue #3 ("2027 outlook"). January 30A workshop scheduled. Rest.	10–15 investors signed or under contract.

Sprint scoreboard (weekly, Friday 9am): conversations · consults booked · consults held · signed agreements · pro formas delivered · offers · contracts · 850-line inbounds · owner letters mailed · videos published · Brief subscribers · partner meetings.

9. 2027 operating plan

Quarter	Closings target	GCI target	Focus	Build
Q1 (Jan–Mar)	7	\$170k	Close sprint pipeline; snowbird season showings; January 30A workshop; ECAR active	ISA or buyer's agent hired by March; ABR course; GRI 101; 45-hour post-license status confirmed
Q2 (Apr–Jun)	10	\$250k	Spring buying peak; listing lane produces; second Birmingham workshop	CCIM CI 101; ILHM training; CPAR + ECAR dual MLS routine; calculator v2 with per-micro-market data
Q3 (Jul–Sep)	10	\$250k	Summer visitors become buyers; on-camera property tours weekly; PM partner referrals	GRI 202; Tax Smart Insiders bench; Google ads scaled on proof
Q4 (Oct–Dec)	13	\$330k	Year-end tax-motivated surge; "Buy by Dec 31" campaign v2; 1031 exits from owner list	2028 plan; team expansion decision
Total	40	\$1.0M		

9.1 Monthly KPI dashboard

KPI	Monthly target	Source
Real investor conversations	104	Brivity
Strategy Sessions held	17	Calendar
Signed buyer/listing agreements	7	Brivity
Pro formas delivered	25	Pro forma log
Offers written	8	Flexmls / Dotloop
Contracts	4	Brivity
Closings / volume / GCI	3.3 / \$3.3M / \$83k	Brivity
850-line inbound calls	20+	Phone log
Owner letters + calls	200 letters / 250 calls	Mail log / dialer
Coastal Blueprint: subs / views / watch hours	+100 subs / 3,000 views / 60 hours by Q1; 1,000 subs by Q4	YouTube Studio
Brief subscribers	+150 per month	Email platform
Google reviews (Florida closings)	Every closing within 7 days	GBP

9.2 Leading-indicator rule

If conversations are on target for four straight weeks and consults are not, fix the script. If consults are on target and signings are not, fix the offer. If signings are on target and contracts are not, fix the underwriting or the buy box. Never fix all three at once.

10. Study guide A: federal tax for beach investors

Study notes for Gene's own fluency. Framed as education for clients, never as advice. Partners (CPA, cost-seg firm, QI) deliver the advice. Verify every figure against the cited primary source before using it in content. Items marked VERIFY had sources blocked during research and need a direct read.

10.1 The short-term rental rule (the "STR loophole")

- **Statute/reg:** Treas. Reg. §1.469-1T(e)(3). An activity is *not* a "rental activity" if the **average guest stay is 7 days or less**, or 30 days or less with significant personal services. If it is not a rental activity, the automatic passive rule does not apply. If the owner **materially participates**, losses are non-passive and offset W-2 and business income.
- **Material participation tests used most (§1.469-5T(a)):** 500+ hours; "substantially all" of the work; or **100+ hours and more than any other individual** (including the cleaner and the property manager). Spouse's hours count. Keep a contemporaneous log. Investor-type hours (reading statements) do not count. Full-service PM arrangements usually defeat the 100-hour test; self-managed or co-hosted setups pass it.
- **What it is not:** a ≤7-day STR is not eligible for the \$25,000 active-participation allowance (that is for rental real estate only), and Real Estate Professional Status (750 hours) is irrelevant to it.
- **Schedule E vs C:** short stays alone do not trigger self-employment tax. SE tax (15.3%) applies only with substantial hotel-like services (daily cleaning during the stay, meals, concierge). Turnover cleaning, linens, Wi-Fi and utilities are not substantial. Most loophole filers stay on Schedule E.
- **Loss cap:** §461(l) excess business loss limit, made permanent by the 2025 tax act: roughly \$313k single / \$626k joint for 2025, indexed for 2026 (VERIFY). Larger cost-seg losses carry forward as NOLs.

10.2 Bonus depreciation and cost segregation

- **100% bonus depreciation is permanent** under the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (P.L. 119-21, July 4, 2025) for qualified property (recovery period ≤20 years) **acquired and placed in service after January 19, 2025**. Property under a binding contract before January 20, 2025 stays on the old phase-down (40% in 2025).
- **Cost segregation** reclassifies 20 to 40% of depreciable basis (furnished STRs typically 22 to 35%) into 5, 7 and 15-year property: furniture, appliances, carpet, decorative lighting, pools, decks, driveways, landscaping, fencing. All of it is bonus-eligible in year one.
- **Study cost:** engineering-based \$5,000 to \$15,000; virtual/flat-fee \$2,000 to \$3,500. Partners: KBKG, Engineered Tax Services, RE Cost Seg.
- **Recapture:** the reclassified 5/7/15-year property is §1245 property; on sale that depreciation is recaptured at **ordinary rates**, not the 25% rate. Plan the exit (hold, 1031, or step-up at death).
- **27.5 vs 39 years:** residential rental (27.5) requires ≥80% of rents from dwelling units; §168(e)(2)(A)(ii)(I) excludes units in a hotel or "other establishment" where more than half the units are transient (<30 days). Practitioners split on whether a single-family STR is an "establishment." Example on \$640k building basis: ~\$23.3k/yr at 27.5 vs ~\$16.4k/yr at 39. Get the CPA's written position.

10.3 Worked example: \$1,000,000 beach-home STR, year one, 35% bracket

Assumption	Value
Price / land share / depreciable basis	\$1,000,000 / 25% / \$750,000; separate furniture package \$50,000
Cost seg reclassification	28% of basis = \$210,000 to 5/7/15-year; \$540,000 remains structure at 27.5 years, placed in service July (first-year factor 1.667%)
Debt	\$750,000 DSCR loan, 7.25%, 30 years; P&I ≈ \$61,400/yr; year-one interest ≈ \$54,000
Operations	Gross rent \$120,000; operating expenses 50% = \$60,000; NOI \$60,000

Tax posture	Average stay ≤ 7 days; owner meets the 100-hour / more-than-anyone test; no substantial services (Schedule E)
Year-one result	Amount
Depreciation: bonus on \$210,000 + bonus on \$50,000 furniture + \$540,000 $\times 1.667\%$	$\approx \$269,000$
Taxable: NOI \$60,000 – interest \$54,000 – depreciation \$269,000	Paper loss $\approx \$263,000$
Non-passive via the STR rule → offsets W-2 at 35% (no Florida income tax)	Federal tax saved $\approx \$92,000$
Pre-tax cash flow: NOI \$60,000 – debt service \$61,400	$\approx -\$1,400$
Cash in: \$250k down + $\sim$ \$25k closing + \$50k furniture + $\sim$ \$5k study	$\approx \$330,000$
After-tax year-one cash return	$\approx +27\%$, driven by the tax refund
Years 2+ depreciation	$\approx \$19,600/\text{yr}$; the shelter is front-loaded (a timing benefit unless held to death or 1031'd)

Check §461(l), AMT, and state tax of the buyer's home state (an Alabama or Georgia resident still pays state tax on the loss offset, which actually increases the benefit at the state level; verify by state). Illustrative only.

10.4 Section 1031 exchanges

- **Timelines:** identify replacement property within **45 days**; close within **180 days** (or the return due date including extensions if earlier). Both clocks run from the relinquished closing. Calendar days.
- **Identification:** 3-property rule, 200% rule, or 95% rule. A Qualified Intermediary is required; the agent, attorney, or CPA from the prior 2 years is a disqualified person. QI fees $\sim$ \$750 to \$1,500 forward; \$2,500 to \$5,000+ reverse/improvement; reverse all-in often \$7,000 to \$15,000+.
- **Reverse exchange:** Rev. Proc. 2000-37; an Exchange Accommodation Titleholder parks the property under a QEAA within 5 business days; same 45/180 limits.
- **Vacation homes "held for investment":** Rev. Proc. 2008-16 safe harbor: for each of the two 12-month periods before (relinquished) and after (replacement) the exchange, rent at fair value ≥ 14 days and keep personal use $\leq$ the greater of 14 days or 10% of rented days. Outside the safe harbor, facts and circumstances (Moore v. Commissioner risk).
- **§121 + §1031:** Rev. Proc. 2005-14 allows the \$250k/\$500k residence exclusion plus deferral on a converted residence; §121(d)(10): no §121 exclusion within 5 years of acquiring property in a 1031; §121(b)(5) prorates for non-qualified (rental) use.

10.5 Personal use, QBI, and the rest

- **§280A personal use:** the home is a "residence" if personal use exceeds the greater of 14 days or 10% of fair-rental days. Then expenses are allocated and rental deductions are capped at rental income (excess carries forward). Repair days do not count as personal use; family and below-market use do. Fewer than 15 rental days: income excluded, no deductions (§280A(g)). Bolton allocation (interest and taxes over 365 days) usually beats the IRS method.
- **QBI (§199A):** 20% deduction made permanent; 2026 thresholds \$201,750 single / \$403,500 joint with wider phase-ins. Rentals qualify as a §162 business or under the Rev. Proc. 2019-38 safe harbor (250+ hours of rental services by owner, employees or contractors; separate books; logs). The safe harbor excludes property used as a residence under §280A(d), so heavy personal use knocks it out.
- **Passive rules for non-STR rentals:** \$25,000 allowance phases out \$1 per \$2 of MAGI above \$100k, gone at \$150k; suspended losses release on full disposition. REPS: 750+ hours and more than half of personal services in real

property businesses, plus material participation.

- **Sale taxes (2026):** unrecaptured §1250 gain at up to 25%; §1245 recapture at ordinary rates; remaining gain at 15%/20% (20% above \$583,400 single / \$613,700 joint); NIIT 3.8% above \$200k/\$250k MAGI (not indexed); income from a materially participated trade or business is generally not NII (confirm). 35% bracket starts at \$256,226 single / \$512,451 joint; 37% above \$640,600 / \$768,700.
- **Estate:** §1014 step-up at death unchanged; exemption \$15M per person from January 1, 2026, indexed. Step-up erases deferred gain and all recapture: the "buy, borrow, 1031, die" ladder.
- **SALT and mortgage interest:** SALT cap \$40,400 in 2026 (phases down above \$500k MAGI); property tax on a rental is a Schedule E expense, not SALT; on a personal second home it is SALT. \$750k acquisition-debt interest cap is permanent and covers primary plus one second home; interest on a rental allocates to Schedule E and is not capped.
- **Opportunity Zones:** Bay County has three current tracts, all in Panama City (tracts 16, 18, 20) through 2028; none on the beach or 30A. OZ 2.0 nominations were due July to September 2026 with new tracts effective January 1, 2027; whether any new Bay County tracts were nominated is unverified. Not a beach-home strategy.

10.6 Flashcards (quiz yourself weekly)

Prompt	Answer
Average stay that makes an STR "not a rental activity"	7 days or less (30 with significant services)
Easiest material participation test for one property	100+ hours and more than anyone else
Bonus depreciation rate and the cutoff date	100%, property acquired after Jan 19, 2025, permanent
Typical cost-seg reclass on a furnished beach home	22–35% of depreciable basis
1031 deadlines	45 days to identify, 180 to close, from the sale closing
Vacation-home 1031 safe harbor	Rev. Proc. 2008-16: 14+ rental days and personal use ≤ greater of 14 days or 10%, each 12-month period, both sides
Personal-use "residence" threshold	Greater of 14 days or 10% of rental days
Recapture rates	§1250 up to 25%; §1245 (cost-seg items) at ordinary rates
NIIT	3.8% above \$200k single / \$250k joint
QBI safe harbor hours	250 hours of rental services per year

11. Study guide B: Florida and local rules, taxes, fees, insurance, financing

11.1 Transfer taxes and who pays what

Item	Rate / amount	Who pays (Walton / Bay custom)
Deed documentary stamps	\$0.70 per \$100 of price	Seller (statewide custom; negotiable in the FR/BAR contract)
Note doc stamps	\$0.35 per \$100 of loan	Buyer
Nonrecurring intangible tax on mortgage	0.2% of loan	Buyer
Owner's title policy	Promulgated: \$5.75/\$1k to \$100k; \$5.00/\$1k \$100k–\$1M; \$2.50/\$1k \$1M–\$5M (≈ \$3,075 at \$600k, \$5,075 at \$1M, \$6,325 at \$1.5M)	Walton: buyer customarily pays. Bay: seller (statewide default); confirm with the title agent.
Lender's policy, recording, survey, appraisal, prepaids, escrows	Varies	Buyer
Commission	Negotiated; Florida average ~5.6% total, ~2.75% list / ~2.8% buyer side (2026 survey); 30A luxury historically 5–6% total with 2.5–3% to the buyer side	Seller, or seller concession to buyer-broker fee per the buyer agreement

Example, \$900,000 price, \$675,000 loan: deed stamps \$6,300 (seller); note stamps \$2,362.50 + intangible \$1,350 = \$3,712.50 (buyer). Financed buyer total ≈ 2–3% of price plus first-year insurance and escrows; cash buyer ≈ 0.5–1% plus the owner's policy in Walton. Seller ≈ 0.7% stamps + commission + title/settlement + prorations (+ owner's policy in Bay).

11.2 Property tax

- **Walton County** FY2025-26 countywide operating millage 3.519 (cut from 3.575). Full South Walton stack (school board, South Walton Fire District, MSTUs) must be pulled from the parcel's TRIM at waltonpa.com (VERIFY). Values are high, per-mill rate relatively low.
- **Bay County** general fund capped at 5.43 mills (flat for FY2025-26). City of Panama City Beach levies 0 city mills; a PCB parcel's total was reported at about 10.79 mills (year unverified). Countywide average ≈ 12.3 mills including ~5.2 school.
- **Investor rules:** no homestead. The 10% annual cap on non-homestead assessed value (§§193.1554/193.1555) does not apply to school levies and is **lost on change of ownership**: the property is reassessed at market value on the January 1 after the sale. **Underwrite taxes on the purchase price, not the seller's bill.** Effective rate on a new PCB purchase ≈ 1.0–1.1% of price; South Walton typically lower per-mill but on higher values.
- A Florida property-tax constitutional amendment is referenced for the November 2026 ballot; content unverified. Track it.

11.3 Taxes on guest rent (stays of 6 months or less)

Tax	South Walton (32459, 32550, 32454, 32461, Walton part of 32413)	Bay County TDT district (all of PCB, Panama City, Mexico Beach, listed unincorporated beach areas)
Florida sales tax	6%	6%

County discretionary surtax	1%	1% (0.5% infrastructure through 2036 + 0.5% school through 2030)
Tourist development (bed) tax	5% (north of the bay: 3% since June 2025)	5% (6th cent rejected in 2025; HB 7031 now requires a referendum for any increase)
Total on guest rent	12%	12%
Remit to	7% to Florida DOR; 5% to Walton Clerk (GovOS/MuniRevs), due the 20th, zero returns required	7% to Florida DOR; 5% to Bay County Clerk (MuniRevs); collection moved to the Tax Collector Oct 1, 2026

Tax base includes rent plus all mandatory non-refundable fees (cleaning, pet). Airbnb and Vrbo collect the 7% state/county portion in Florida; whether they remit the county-administered TDT for a given listing must be confirmed with each clerk. Self-managing owners are liable for anything not remitted. Walton is actively pursuing unregistered rentals in 2026.

11.4 Licenses and registrations an STR buyer needs

Jurisdiction	Requirement	Cost / key rules
State (DBPR, Ch. 509)	Vacation Rental – Dwelling license if rented more than 3 times a year for under 30 days or advertised as regularly rented; Florida DOR sales tax certificate; balcony certificate for 3+ stories	~\$230 first year (\$50 app + \$10 fee + \$170 license); ~\$180/yr after
Walton County (unincorporated: all of 30A, Santa Rosa Beach, Miramar Beach, Inlet Beach)	Short-Term Vacation Rental Certificate for any rental under 30 days (BCC Res. 2024-57, effective Feb 1, 2025)	\$300/yr per property (\$227 community-managed); \$500/day penalty unregistered; renewal cycle moves to June 1–May 31 starting 2026-27 (window opens April 1); occupancy 150 sq ft per person; no street parking (exact parking formula: verify); responsible party 18+, reachable 24/7, on site within 1 hour; certificate number in all ads; rules posted inside
City of Panama City Beach (Ord. 1632, effective Feb 1, 2024)	Annual Vacation Rental Certificate after life-safety inspection; needs DBPR license, Bay TDT registration, city Business Tax Receipt	\$250 new, \$150 annual renewal, \$75 re-inspection, \$100 lock-out; occupancy 1 per 150 sq ft habitable; off-street parking; certificate number in ads; 24/7 responsible party; no caps, no owner-occupancy, no minimum stay; confirm zoning district with PCB Planning before buying an R-1 lot (sources conflict)
Unincorporated Bay County (Laguna Beach, Sunnyside, parts of 32413; Ord. 23-18, Aug 2023)	Annual STR certificate for 1–4 family dwellings	\$250 initial inspection; notarized affidavit, fire-safety checklist, TDT and DBPR proof; posted emergency contact, alarms, extinguishers, beach-flag signage
City of Panama City; City of Mexico Beach	Not verified; call each planning/code office before writing an STR offer	Both inside the 5% Bay TDT district

State preemption: §509.032(7)(b) bars local bans and duration/frequency limits (pre-June 2011 ordinances grandfathered); registration, inspection and reasonable fees are allowed. SB 280 (2024) was vetoed; nothing passed in 2025; the only 2026 STR-adjacent bill died March 13, 2026. The local regime above is the operating framework.

11.5 HOA and covenant map (verify every parcel's CC&Rs)

- **30A communities reported restricted or no-STR:** The Retreat, WaterSound Origins, WaterSound Camp Creek, Heritage Dunes, Draper Lake, Gulf Place—Bella Mar, Lakeview Estates, Lake Place, Sea Dunes, Village of White Cliffs, Sand Cliffs, Ridgewalk, The Estuary, Eden's Landing, Emerald Walk/Flamingo Village; Alys Beach and sections of WaterSound Beach have strict or no-STR rules; not all Rosemary Beach sections allow STR.
- **30A communities where STR is generally allowed under HOA rules:** Seaside, WaterColor (one of the strongest STR submarkets), Seacrest Beach (rental community with tram and pool), Seagrove, Grayton Beach, Blue Mountain Beach, Dune Allen, Inlet Beach older non-HOA plats (last four not individually confirmed).
- **Bay County:** Carillon Beach (inside PCB city limits) allows STR under HOA rules with QR-code gate entry and a \$35-per-vehicle renter parking fee; Laguna Beach and Bid-A-Wee have active STR inventory with no prohibitions found (unverified).

11.6 Insurance and risk (2025–2026)

- **Market is healing:** Florida carriers posted an 83% combined ratio in 2025; 21 new carriers since the 2022–23 reforms; Citizens fell from 1.42M policies to ~395k by January 2026 and cut 2026 rates (–8.8% multiperil, –5.5% wind-only). Citizens 2026 average premium: Walton \$3,873, Bay \$2,834. Indicative: Inlet Beach ≈ \$8,400/yr on a ~\$1.4M home; a \$1M to \$1.5M coastal home runs roughly \$6k to \$15k+ wind-inclusive depending on year built, roof, openings and distance to the Gulf.
- **Wind-mitigation credits (form OIR-B1-1802):** 2001+ Florida Building Code homes qualify for most of the wind discount; opening protection 30–45%, hip roof 28–32%, plus SWR, deck attachment and roof-to-wall straps; statutory ceiling ~88% of the wind portion. New construction wins on insurance. The 9th Edition Florida Building Code takes effect December 31, 2026.
- **My Safe Florida Home** grants are homestead-only (owner-occupied, ≤\$700k insured value, pre-2008): investor properties are not eligible.
- **Flood (NFIP Risk Rating 2.0):** priced on elevation, first-floor height, distance to water and replacement cost, not just zone. Indicative 2026 premiums: AE \$2,000–\$6,000; VE \$5,000–\$15,000+. Gulf-front lots are typically VE; first rows north of 30A and Front Beach Road often AE or X. Lenders require flood coverage in A/V zones; NFIP maxes at \$250k building, so \$600k+ homes need excess/private flood. Walton's FIRM is effective December 30, 2020; Walton is CRS Class 6 (20% NFIP discount in the SFHA).
- **Insurance drives DSCR:** every \$5,000 of extra premium drops DSCR by \$5,000 ÷ annual PITIA. On a \$750k loan (~\$61k P&I) with \$100k rent, a \$12k premium versus \$6k moves DSCR from ~1.3 to ~1.2 and can push a deal under a lender's floor. Quote before you inspect.
- **Disclosures on listings:** flood disclosure (HB 1049, effective Oct 1, 2024) and CCCL disclosure/affidavit (\$161.57) for property seaward of the Coastal Construction Control Line (FDEP "Locate the CCCL" tool; DEP permit required for construction seaward).

11.7 Financing (2026)

Path	Terms	Use when
Second-home (Fannie B2-1.1-01)	10% down minimum; borrower occupies part of the year, no PM agreement controlling occupancy, rental income not used to qualify; LLPAs 1.125% (≤60% LTV) to 4.125% (85–90%), about +0.875% in rate at 80% LTV versus primary	Buyer wants personal use and the best rate; conforming limit \$832,750 for 2026 (Walton and Bay are not high-cost counties: verify); above that is jumbo
Investment property (agency)	15% down minimum, most lenders price best at 20–25%; higher LLPAs; rental income can qualify	No personal use planned; conforming balance

DSCR (non-QM)	6.5–8.25% (STR often 7–9%); 75–80% max LTV; min DSCR 1.0–1.25 (some to 0.75 with pricing hits); FICO 660–680+; 2–12 months reserves; AirDNA/Rabbu or 12-month history for income; prepay penalties common; closes in an LLC	High-DTI or self-employed buyers, LLC ownership, jumbo balances, speed
Cash	Florida ran ~41% all-cash in 2024; 30A luxury "commonly cash" (local share unverified)	Year-end tax buyers, 1031 buyers; offer to arrange delayed financing after close
Seller financing / HELOC	Dodd-Frank seller-financer exemptions (≤ 3 properties/yr); agency cash-out on investment property typically ~75% LTV (verify)	Long-held out-of-state owners with no debt: a listing-lane tool

11.8 Returns benchmarks for the pro forma

Price tier	Panama City Beach gross (indicative)	30A gross (indicative)	Gross yield
\$600k	3BR house/townhome off-beach \$45k–\$65k	West-end townhome/cottage \$40k–\$60k	7–10%
\$900k	4BR with pool near beach \$70k–\$100k	3–4BR north of 30A \$70k–\$100k	8–11%
\$1.5M	Gulf-view/front 4–5BR \$110k–\$160k	4–5BR south of 30A, short walk \$120k–\$180k	8–12%

- Local PM data (Short Term Shop): 4BR 30A $\approx$ \$101k at \$480 ADR; 6+BR $\approx$ \$184k at \$850 ADR; Gulf-front earns 30–50% more than off-beach comps. AirROI (Jun 2025–May 2026): Inlet Beach median $\approx$ \$70k, top quartile $\approx$ \$105k, top decile $\approx$ \$148k at ~40% occupancy.
- **Expense ratio:** management 20–30% on 30A (15–20% for high-revenue homes); total operating expenses excluding debt and depreciation $\approx$ 50–60% of gross for professionally managed beach homes (management, cleaning/supplies, utilities and internet \$6–9k, insurance \$6–15k, property tax ~1% of price, maintenance/pool/landscape 5–10%, HOA, platform fees, furnishings reserve).
- **Cap rates** commonly 3–6% at today's prices; with 75% LTV at 7–8% DSCR pricing, pre-tax cash-on-cash is often 0% to low single digits (negative in year one). The case rests on appreciation, personal use, and the tax engine.
- **Break-even occupancy** = (fixed costs + debt service) $\div$ (ADR $\times$ 365 $\times$ (1 – variable-cost %)). Example: \$45k fixed + \$61k debt = \$106k; ADR \$500; variable 30% $\rightarrow$ ~41% occupancy.

11.9 What changed in 2025–2026 (talk track for the Brief)

1. Federal: 100% bonus depreciation permanent (acquired after Jan 19, 2025); QBI permanent; SALT cap \$40,400 for 2026; \$750k interest cap permanent; estate exemption \$15M; OZ 2.0 tracts effective Jan 1, 2027.
2. Walton: \$300 STR certificate (Feb 2025), renewal cycle shifts to June 1 for 2026-27, enforcement escalating, north-of-bay TDT 3%, county millage cut to 3.519.
3. Bay: bed-tax hike rejected; HB 7031 requires a referendum for increases; half-cent surtax renewed through 2036; millage flat at 5.43; PCB Ordinance 1632 in its renewal years; TDT collection moved to the Tax Collector Oct 1, 2026.
4. State: SB 280 vetoed, nothing passed in 2025 or 2026; FBC 9th Edition Dec 31, 2026; Florida Realtors new forms Jan 5, 2026.
5. Insurance: Citizens cuts, private market profitable, Walton/Bay averages \$3,873/\$2,834.
6. Financing: conforming limit \$832,750; DSCR 6.5–8.25%.
7. Markets: PCB STR revenue +21% with ADR down ~16% (occupancy up); 30A/Inlet Beach revenue +17% at ~40% occupancy; 30A closings +35%, PCB +19%.

12. Certifications and education sequence

Status today: Florida sales associate license held since June 2024 (so no mutual-recognition path needed; confirm the 45-hour post-license course was completed before the first renewal and that the 14-hour CE cycle is on track). Alabama license since 2009. SRS. CPAR member (2026 dues available now; 10% discount if paid by November 1). Not yet an ECAR member, which is required for Walton County MLS access and the 30A lane.

Credential / course	Provider · cost · format	Why for this niche	Priority	When
ECAR secondary membership + Flexmls + Supra	Emerald Coast Association of Realtors · ~\$300 app + prorated local dues + Florida Realtors \$176 + MLS \$35/mo + Supra ~\$54 + \$17/mo (2025 packet; verify 2026)	Walton County MLS access. Without it there is no 30A business.	MUST	Week 1
Hall CPA / Tax Smart Investors STR Tax Course	\$247 · self-paced video	The definitive practitioner course on the STR rule, material participation, cost seg	MUST	Weeks 1–3
IRS Pub 527, 925, 946, 544	Free · irs.gov	Vacation-home rules, passive activity and material participation, depreciation, dispositions	MUST	Weeks 1–4
"Short-Term Rental, Long-Term Wealth" (Avery Carl)	~\$25 · book	The framework most of Gene's prospects have already read	MUST	Week 2
KBKG and Engineered Tax Services cost-seg webinars	Free · 1 hour each	How a residential cost-seg study is built; KBKG residential calculator for illustrations	MUST	Weeks 2–4
IPX1031 / Asset Preservation / First American Exchange 1031 webinars	Free · CE where approved	Forward, reverse, improvement exchanges; DST backups	MUST	Weeks 3–6
RSPS – Resort & Second-Home Property Specialist	NAR · \$135 online / \$187 live webinar + application fee (verify current) · 1 day	The one NAR credential literally about this market; counts as ABR elective	MUST	Weeks 3–6
NAR Real Estate Investing (REI) certification	RRC · \$126 member / \$187 · 6 CE hours online · 5 courses (APOD, rentals, PM essentials, investor needs, working with investors)	Exactly the pitch; double-counts toward CRS	MUST	Weeks 7–12
C2EX	NAR · free · self-paced	Ethics credential, zero cost	NICE	Q4
ABR	REBAC · ~\$500–\$700 all-in · 2-day core + RSPS as elective	Post-settlement buyer-agreement competence; buyer-advisory positioning	STRONG	Q1 2027
GRI 101 and GRI 202 (Florida)	Florida Realtors · ~\$66–\$199 per module · 15 hrs each	101 gives 15 hours post-license credit; 202 is the investment and tax module	STRONG	Q1 / Q3 2027

CCIM CI 101 (Financial Analysis)	CCIM Institute · \$1,299 member (+\$695 candidate membership) · ~4 days	The single best "returns expert" course: NPV, IRR, cash-flow modeling. Full CCIM is overkill for 1–4 unit STRs	STRONG	Q2 2027
ILHM luxury training (toward CLHMS / GUILD)	Institute for Luxury Home Marketing · \$545 + \$295/yr · 2 days + documented upper-tier sales	\$600k+ on 30A is entry luxury; thresholds are local, so attainable in 2027	STRONG	Q2 2027
Tax Smart Insiders (6 months)	Hall CPA · \$97/mo	CPA bench to answer client questions fast	STRONG	Q3 2027
InterNACHI wind-mitigation course	Free online	Read the OIR-B1-1802 form and talk insurance credits like a pro	STRONG	Q1 2027
BiggerPockets STR Bootcamp	~\$300–\$1,000 · 8–10 weeks (enrollment windows; verify)	Investor-side curriculum from the Short Term Shop founders	NICE	2027 cohort if timing fits
VRMA Vacation Rental Management Certificate	\$450 member / \$750 · online	Only if Gene intends to vet or partner with PMs formally	NICE	Q4 2027
CRS, CIPS, SRS (held), e-PRO	Various	CRS later via REI double-count; CIPS deferred (international buyers are a small share); e-PRO marginal	NICE	2028
Enrolled Agent	~\$1,100 + 72 hrs CE / 3 yrs	Not recommended. Creates tax-practice liability expectations. Build the CPA bench instead.	—	—

Reading list (in order): Pub 527 → Pub 925 → "Short-Term Rental, Long-Term Wealth" → Pub 946 → Hall CPA STR course → "Tax Strategies for the Savvy Real Estate Investor" (Han/MacFarland) → "Tax-Free Wealth" (Wheelwright) → Pub 544 → Walton VRC ordinance and PCB Ordinance 1632 → Florida Realtors Jan 5, 2026 forms release (SA-5, compensation modification) → Florida flood disclosure (HB 1049) and CCCL disclosure (\$161.57) guidance.

12-month education spend: about \$4,500 to \$6,000 including CI 101; about \$3,000 without. Association and MLS costs are in Section 13.

13. Fees, costs, and budget

13.1 Business budget (Oct 2026 – Dec 2027)

Line	Q4 2026	2027	Notes
ECAR secondary membership, Florida Realtors, Flexmls, Supra	\$900	\$1,200	2025 packet figures; verify 2026
CPAR dues, MLS, Supra	\$820	\$820	\$360 dues (10% off by Nov 1) + \$276 MLS + \$180 Supra
Education and credentials	\$900	\$4,500	Section 12
Data: PropStream, AirDNA Market Research, DealCheck	\$600	\$2,600	PropStream \$99–\$199/mo; AirDNA ~\$400/yr; DealCheck ~\$120/yr
Dialer / ISA tool (one of Mojo, REDX, Vulcan7)	\$300	\$1,800	Start with Mojo single line
Direct mail (letters + postcards)	\$1,200	\$9,000	500–1,000 pieces a month at ~\$1–\$1.50
Paid ads (Google, YouTube, Meta)	\$2,400	\$14,000	Scale only on proof
Video production (editing, thumbnails, B-roll)	\$600	\$3,600	Claude handles scripts, captions, posting
Workshops (venue, food, AV) ×5	\$1,500	\$6,000	Partners co-fund
Florida travel (2 weekends a month)	\$1,800	\$7,200	Fuel, lodging; offset by partner stays
850 line, landing page, email platform	\$300	\$1,200	
ISA / buyer's agent (from Q2 2027)	\$0	\$30,000+	Base + bonus or split; decision in Q1
Total	~\$11,300	~\$82,000	About 8% of the \$1M GCI goal; about 15% of the floor scenario

13.2 Closing-cost cheat sheet (who pays what in Walton and Bay)

Scenario	Buyer pays (approx.)	Seller pays (approx.)
\$600k, financed 80%, Walton	Note stamps \$1,680 + intangible \$960 + owner's policy ~\$3,075 + lender's policy, recording, survey, appraisal, prepaids ≈ 2.5–3% (\$15k–\$18k) plus first-year insurance	Deed stamps \$4,200 + commission + title/settlement + prorations
\$1.0M, financed 75%, Bay	Note stamps \$2,625 + intangible \$1,500 + lender's policy, recording, survey, appraisal, prepaids ≈ 2–2.5% (\$20k–\$25k) plus insurance	Deed stamps \$7,000 + owner's policy ~\$5,075 + commission + title/settlement + prorations
\$1.5M, cash, Walton	Owner's policy ~\$6,325 + recording, survey, inspections ≈ 0.6–1% (\$9k–\$15k)	Deed stamps \$10,500 + commission + title/settlement + prorations

Buyer-broker compensation is written into the buyer agreement and requested as a seller concession in the offer where the listing does not offer it. Confirm county title custom with the closing agent; Bay custom is the statewide default (seller pays owner's policy) and was not independently confirmed.

14. Scripts and templates

14.1 Out-of-state owner letter (hand-signed, 850 line)

Dear [First name],

You own [address] in [Inlet Beach / Panama City Beach]. I work with investors from Birmingham, Atlanta, Nashville and Dallas who are buying beach homes like yours by the numbers, and I'm writing to you for two reasons.

First, if you've ever wondered what your home would gross as a rental in 2026, or what it would sell for to an investor who underwrites on verified actuals rather than a Zestimate, I'll run that for you at no cost and no obligation. Text **BEACH** to **850-964-3554** and I'll send it within two business days.

Second, if you've been thinking about selling, trading up, or moving your equity into another property with a 1031 exchange, there is a window at year-end that matters for buyers, which means it matters for sellers too. I'm happy to explain it in ten minutes.

I've sold more than 2,000 homes over 17 years and I'm an accredited investor myself. I run the numbers first.

Gene Darden · The Darden Group · Real Broker LLC | Powered by PLACE · Florida line 850-964-3554 ·

gene@dardengroupusa.com

Licensed in Florida and Alabama. Equal Housing Opportunity. If your property is listed with another broker, this is not a solicitation.

14.2 Owner call track (skip-traced)

Open: "Hi [name], Gene Darden with The Darden Group, I'm a Florida-licensed agent and investor. I sent you a note about your place on [street] in [area]. Did it reach you? ... Quick reason for the call: I'm pulling 2026 rental actuals and sale comps for owners on [street]. Do you rent it, use it, or both?"

If rents: "What did it gross last year, roughly? ... With management at [X]% and this year's insurance, are you happy with the net? ... Investors I work with are paying for verified actuals right now. If I could show you what it's worth to that buyer and what you'd net after a 1031, would that be worth 15 minutes?"

If personal use only: "Have you ever thought about what it would take to have it pay for itself the weeks you're not there? ... I can run that in a day."

Close: "Easiest next step: I'll text you from 850-964-3554 so you have me, and I'll send the numbers by [day]. Fair?"

14.3 Feeder-network conversation (Birmingham sphere)

"Quick one. I've expanded the Florida side of the business to beach homes from 30A to Panama City Beach, specifically for people who want them to pay for themselves and want the tax side done right. Who do you know who has talked about buying a beach house in the last year? ... Great. Would you be open to introducing us by text? I'll send a two-line intro you can forward."

14.4 Strategy Session agenda (45 minutes)

1. Why the beach, and why now (5 min): personal use intent, timeline, family.
2. Capital and financing path (10 min): cash, second-home, DSCR, 1031 proceeds, HELOC; pre-approval status.
3. Tax position (10 min): bracket, W-2 vs business income, spouse's hours, ability to materially participate, existing passive losses. (Frame, don't advise.)
4. Buy box (10 min): micro-markets, bedroom count, distance to beach, new vs resale, HOA tolerance, STR vs LTR vs second home.
5. Next steps (10 min): sign buyer agreement, lender intro, insurance broker intro, first three properties with pro formas, Florida weekend date.

14.5 Year-end investor email (send Nov 2)

Subject: The beach-home deadline most buyers miss (Dec 31)

[First name], a property placed in service as a rental by December 31 takes its first-year depreciation on that year's return, and 100% bonus depreciation is back for property acquired after January 19, 2025. On a \$1.2M 30A home with a cost-segregation study, that can mean a six-figure paper loss in year one. Whether it offsets your W-2 income depends on the short-term-rental material-participation rules, which I explain in this week's video: [link].

I have [N] homes from Inlet Beach to Panama City Beach that can close before year-end, each with verified rental actuals and a one-page pro forma. Reply, or text 850-964-3554, and I'll send the three that fit your numbers.

Gene

Educational only, not tax advice. Confirm with your CPA.

14.6 One-page pro forma spec (the deliverable)

Block	Fields
Property	Address, micro-market, type, beds/baths, sq ft, year built, flood zone, STR eligibility (certificate path), HOA rules
Revenue	Trailing-12 actuals (source) or comp set (AirDNA/Rabbu, bedroom count, distance), ADR, occupancy, gross; haircut applied
Expenses	Management %, cleaning pass-through, bed tax and sales tax (guest-paid), insurance quote (wind + flood), property tax at purchase price, HOA, utilities, maintenance, supplies, capex reserve
Debt	Loan type, down, rate, term, P&I, DSCR
Returns	NOI, cap rate, cash flow, cash-on-cash; appreciation; principal paydown; year-one depreciation with cost seg + bonus; estimated tax savings at buyer's bracket; total year-one return
Five-year	IRR, equity at exit, 1031 path, downside case
Footer	Verified Actuals stamp or "Projection only"; disclaimer; 850 line

15. Risks, compliance, and guardrails

Risk	Mitigation
Tax content drifts into advice	Standard disclaimer on everything; partners deliver advice; never model a client's return, only illustrate; confirm E&O covers investment-analysis marketing
Insurance shock kills deals late	Insurance quotes (wind + flood) in hand before the inspection period ends; broker on the bench; new-code construction preferred
STR rule changes (Walton renewal cycle, PCB inspections, state preemption bills)	Monthly Brief tracks changes; verify certificate eligibility before writing; never promise rental permission
Spreading across two counties and two states too thin	Q4 2026: PCB first (existing presence), west 30A second; ISA by Q2; two Florida weekends a month, fixed
Licensing and association compliance	Keep Florida and Alabama licenses in good standing; CE on schedule; Florida license number on all Florida marketing; buyer-broker agreement before every showing; Florida Realtors Jan 2026 forms; flood and CCCL disclosures on listings; respond promptly and completely to any regulator correspondence
Hurricane season (June–Nov) and market shocks	Downside case in every pro forma; buyers reserve one season of carry; diversify lanes (listings + buyers + referrals)
Fair housing and advertising	Equal Housing Opportunity on all materials; no steering language in micro-market content; brokerage name on every ad
Over-promising rental income	Verified Actuals Standard; written "projection only" label; no "guaranteed" language

16. Appendix

16.1 The MLS query that replaces the estimates

Flexmls (CPAR now; ECAR when active). Save as "FL Investor Segment – Monthly".

- Status: Closed · Closed date: 01/01/2026 to today
- Property type: Residential – Detached, Residential – Attached/Townhouse (exclude Condo, Lots/Land, Multi-family unless 1–4 units)
- County: Walton; then Bay (run separately)
- Sold price: ≥ \$600,000; second run ≥ \$1,000,000
- Export: count, total sold volume, median and average sold price, average DOM, financing type (cash share), sold-to-list ratio, listing office and selling office (for competitor share)
- Bonus run: Active + Pending with the same filters for months-of-inventory; Expired/Withdrawn ≥ \$800,000 last 24 months for the listing lane

Repeat on the first business day of every month. Log in the scorecard and use as the Beach Investor Brief headline.

16.2 Data notes

Research was conducted October 4, 2026. Source pages on brokerage, MLS, association, and data-vendor domains could not be opened directly from the research environment; figures were taken from indexed search excerpts of those pages and are labeled HARD only where a named source reported them. Estimates use the methods described in Section 3. Competitor production figures are RealTrends Verified 2026 (2025 production) or self-reported, as marked. All tax and regulatory items should be verified against the primary source before publication.

16.3 Key sources

Market data: beonthecoast.com 30A market update (Sept 14, 2026) · pcbproperty.com 30A updates (Mar, Apr 2026) · sellfl.net PCB/30A updates (Jul, Sept 2026) · beachrealty.net (May 2026) · davisprop.com 30A condo update · 30a.com selling guide · WJHG \$41M sale (Apr 30, 2026) · Homes.com \$16.7M record and 32459 growth · Redfin Walton County, Santa Rosa Beach, Miramar Beach, Rosemary Beach, PCB, Bay County pages · RealtyTrac Walton · movewithmomentum.com 32550, Bay County, Panama City · FRED MEDLISPRI18880 · HouseCanary Florida · Houzeo PCB · seltzerrealestate.com PCB SFH · Homes.com Panama City and Lynn Haven · Florida Realtors July 2025 MSA summary, 2025 year-end, Q1 2026 luxury report · SoWal TDT threads · Walton Clerk FY2025 ACFR · WJHG Bay bed tax (Jul 2026) · AirDNA Santa Rosa Beach and PCB · Rabbu PCB · AirROI Santa Rosa Beach and Inlet Beach · The Short Term Shop revenue and expense pages · Mid Bay News STR enforcement.

Competition: RealTrends team profiles (Spears Group, Dahler & Co., Blankenship Watkins) · RealTrends Compass 30A article · Dahler-commissioned ranking page (GitHub) · HousingWire RealTrends Verified 2026 · spearsgroupfl.com · 30arealestatefl.com · thekendallhoodcollection.com · scenicisr.com blog · 30arealty.com and Yahoo Finance (Christie's launch) · Corcoran Reverie newswire releases · VIE Magazine and South Walton Life (Engel & Völkers) · searchcoastalluxury.com · thesmileof30a.com · durangroupfl.com · Seltzer newswire/NatLawReview · countsrealestate.com · beachybeach.com · theshorttermshop.com · 360blue.com/realtors · oversee.us · Lendmire, Ridge Street Capital, Pinnacle Funding DSCR pages · Clever/Houzeo/flatfeemlsells Florida commission surveys · mywaltonfl.gov VRC pages · pcbfl.gov/295 · Real Producers Emerald Coast issues.

Tax and rules: Treas. Reg. §1.469-1T(e)(3), §1.469-5T · IRC §§168, 199A, 280A, 461(l), 469, 1014, 1031, 1245, 1250, 1411 · P.L. 119-21 (OBBBA) summaries from Thomson Reuters, BDO, Jones Day, Warren Averett · Rev. Proc. 2000-37, 2005-14, 2008-16, 2019-38 · wcginc.com, morkelfinancial.com, taxstra.com, costsegsmart.com, overlineiq.com, recostseg.com, virtualcostsegregation.com, docwealth.com, firstexchange.com, thetaxadviser.com, legal1031.com, cbiz.com, ipx1031.com, accruit.com, nationaltaxtools.com, law.cornell.edu, hiltzikcpa.com, therealestatecpa.com, taxfoundation.org, lawvex.com, opportunityzones.com, eig.org, floridajobs.org OZ 2.0 · Florida DOR GT-800014, DR-15TDT, DR-15DSS, TIP 24A01-21, GT-800034 · barneswalker.com, realestateforsale30afl.com, titlecapture.com, pozek.com · mypanhandle.com and midbaynews.com millage coverage · baycountyleftax.gov millage · §193.1554 F.S. · waltonclerkfl.gov touristtax · baycoclerk.com TDT · HB 7031 (2025) · DBPR VRTSP guide · mywaltonfl.gov Vacation Rental Certification Program and FAQs · Walton BCC Res. 2024-57 · PCB Ordinance 1632 · Bay County Ord. 23-18 · §509.032(7)(b) F.S. · WMNF (SB 280 veto) · 30alifestyleagent.com, sowal.com, 30abeachescapes.com, carillonbeach.com HOA pages · Insurance Journal, Citizens 2026 rates, movewithmomentum insurance pages, latentinsure.com, ICC FBC 2026, mysafehome.com, floodinsuranceguru.com, mywaltonfl.gov FEMA zones · FHFA 2026 limits, Fannie Mae B2-1.1-01 and LLPA matrix, dscrfinder.com, griffinffunding.com, Florida Realtors cash-sale articles · Florida Realtors Jan 2026 forms, HB 1049 flood disclosure, §161.57 CCCL disclosure.

Education: NAR RSPS, REI, ABR, C2EX, e-PRO pages · RRC/CRS · CCIM Institute tuition · Florida Realtors GRI · ILHM · VRMA · emeraldcoastrealtors.com membership and education · cpar.us billing and fee schedules · Hall CPA / Tax Smart Investors · KBKG and Engineered Tax Services webinars · IPX1031, First American Exchange, API webinars · IRS Pubs 527, 925, 946, 544 · BiggerPockets STR publications · InterNACHI

wind-mitigation course · PropStream, AirDNA, Rabbu, DealCheck, Mojo, REDX, Vulcan7 pricing pages · Walton and Bay County Property Appraiser tax-roll exports.